

THREAT INTELLIGENCE REPORT

THE FIRST 24 HOURS

Almost everything the security industry knows about malicious domains is learned *after* they attack. This report is the opposite: a complete census of the world's new domains **before** anyone has decided whether they are good or bad — **66 million domains, observed at a median age of one day.**

213 consecutive daily cohorts 66,088,397 domains 69,367,399 active scans median scan lag +1 day

13d

median gap between registration and attack

26%

of confirmed phishing domains are newly registered

52.4%

of new domains serve no real content at 24h

17%

are weaponised within the first 24 hours

01 WHY THIS ANSWERS DIFFERENT QUESTIONS

Blocklists, threat feeds and reputation services are retrospective by construction — a domain has already been used by the time they know about it. Webamon ingests the ICANN registration feed daily and actively scans **every domain on it**, usually within 24 hours.

Three properties that matter

Complete — every domain in the feed is scanned. No sampling, no prioritisation, no watchlist bias. When this report says 37.8% of new domains are blank, that is 37.8% of *all* of them.

Early — median and 95th-percentile scan lag is **+1 day**.

Active — real scans of page content, DOM, TLS certificate, hosting and redirects. Not WHOIS, not passive DNS.

Verified scan lag

Measured across five cohorts spanning February to July 2026.

COHORT	SCANS	MEDIAN	P95
2026-02-10	291,494	+1d	+2d
2026-04-15	395,556	+1d	+2d
2026-06-10	277,479	+1d	+1d
2026-07-01	427,504	+1d	+1d
2026-07-15	585,058	+1d	+2d

Every figure in this report therefore describes domains at roughly **24–48 hours of age**.

02 THE MARKET — VOLUME AND RHYTHM

Registration grew 58% in seven months

Average new domains per day, by month.



The attack surface available to an adversary is expanding faster than most defensive programmes are scaling.

Registration follows an office calendar

Median new domains by day of week. Weekend = 71.7% of weekday.



Alerting built on raw registration counts **will fire every weekend** and miss genuine weekday events. Volume anomaly detection must be day-of-week normalised.

03 WHAT A NEW DOMAIN LOOKS LIKE AT 24 HOURS

A complete census of the state of the world's new domains on day one. **52.4% are not serving real content when first scanned** — and the single largest category is nothing at all.

State at first scan



Dormancy is not safety — it is inventory

A domain that is blank on day one has not been abandoned. It has been **acquired**.

Registration is cheap, and the pattern across our sector research is consistent: buy in bulk, let the domain age past the window where newly-registered-domain reputation controls are most aggressive, then activate.

In our financial-services research, a bank-phishing domain sat dead for **28 consecutive days** before flipping to a live credential-harvesting page for a 22-day operational window.

Blocking on domain age alone does not defeat this. Age tells you when a domain was bought, not what it is for. Content-based observation at first appearance does.

04 TLD INTENT FINGERPRINTS

The share of a TLD's new domains actually doing something at 24 hours varies by **4×**, and is stable enough to use as a risk input.

Live content at 24 hours, by TLD

Grey = predominantly bought and left dark.



Two registration economies

Buy-and-hold — .lol (16.5% live), .top (23.3%), .asia (31.3%). Bought in bulk, left dark. The domain is inventory. These are also the TLDs most heavily represented in the bulk-abuse infrastructure across our iGaming, financial-services and government research.

Buy-and-use — .store (67.1%), .xyz (65.6%), .site (64.3%). Live inside 24 hours.

Note: .app and .dev are HSTS-preloaded and require working HTTPS, which mechanically inflates their blank rate. Their dormancy is partly technical.

How to use this. A high blank rate is not a reason to relax — it signals a TLD functioning as a holding pen, whose domains deserve *re-observation* rather than a one-time verdict. Conversely, an unexpectedly live domain inside a high-blank TLD is anomalous against its own population and worth prioritising.

05 BULK REGISTRATION EVENTS

Single-day bulk registration is routine, reaching **30×** a TLD's normal day. Because every domain is scanned, we can establish what each event actually was rather than inferring

from volume.

TLD	DATE	DOMAINS	VS OWN MEDIAN	WHAT IT WAS
.cfd	2026-05-11	41,961	30.0×	Generated domains; parking + "Phone Number Lookup" lead capture
.sbs	2026-02-12	46,740	23.1×	8-character generated domains, largely unconfigured
.asia	2026-02-03	15,238	17.3×	Single operator — 12,355 identical pages
.xyz	2026-06-11	82,055	9.7×	SEO citation network, 67,752 on Akamai
.app	2026-05-04	49,548	8.7×	Legitimate — registry pricing promotion

The largest: 82,055 domains in one day

Unusually, plausible English word-pairs rather than random strings — northamericanscroll.xyz, serenityscroll.xyz, backyardswipe.xyz.

67,752 of 82,055 hosted on Akamai, certificates from GoDaddy/Starfield, serving "Local Citation Links". The naming discipline, volume and Tier-1 CDN hosting mark this out as a professionally-operated SEO network, and a material contributor to .xyz's 2026 growth.

Not every spike is an attack

On 2026-05-04, .app hit 8.7× and .dev hit 7.8× — the same day. Both are operated by the same registry, and the domains were ordinary product names.

This was a pricing promotion, not an attack. Volume alone cannot tell the difference.

Registry-level co-movement should be excluded before bulk registration is treated as adversarial — which requires having scanned the domains, not just counted them.

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FROM REGISTRATION TO ATTACK — THE 13-DAY WINDOW

The most operationally significant finding in this report.

A quarter of confirmed-bad infrastructure is freshly registered

THREAT FEED	SAMPLED	NEWLY REGISTERED
Phishing	6,000	25.9%
Malware distribution	3,802	20.5%

A full day-one content scan of each of these domains already exists — dated and fingerprinted — from roughly two weeks before the industry flagged it.

Time from registration to being flagged

	PHISHING	MALWARE
p25	+4d	+5d
Median	+13d	+13d
p75	+37d	+21d
within 24h	17.1%	6.0%
within 7d	35.8%	30.8%
within 30d	68.5%	80.9%

Two readings for defenders. There is a **~2-week window** in which a malicious domain exists, has been observed, and is invisible to any control that depends on reputation — usable retrospectively the moment an indicator is published. But **17.1% of newly-registered phishing domains are weaponised within 24 hours**. Same-day attack is not an edge case, and no reputation system can help, because there is no history to have a reputation from.

07

WHERE NEW DOMAINS LIVE

Infrastructure at 24 hours is heavily concentrated, which shapes what blocking and

takedown can realistically achieve.

Hosting

PROVIDER	SCANS
Google	11,557,177
Cloudflare	10,091,403
Amazon	9,211,007
Akamai	6,260,388
Fastly	3,682,584

Certificate issuers

ISSUER	SCANS
Google Trust Services (WR2)	9,830,684
Google Trust Services (WE1)	7,684,031
Starfield Secure CA - G2	5,522,509
Go Daddy Secure CA - G2	4,228,374
Let's Encrypt (R13)	3,209,385

A TLS certificate is not a trust signal on a domain this young. Issuance is automated, free and instant, and appears on malicious and benign registrations alike within the first day.

DETECTION & CONTROLS

1. **Don't rely on domain age alone.** Over half of new domains are deliberately dormant on day one, and adversaries age infrastructure specifically to clear age thresholds.
2. **Don't treat TLS as reassurance** on a domain under ~30 days old.
3. **Assume a 13-day lead time and use it.** When an indicator lands, look backwards — the day-one profile usually already exists and can date the campaign and expose sibling domains still dormant.
4. **Plan for the 17% that attack immediately.** Reputation cannot see same-day weaponisation.

RISK SCORING

1. **Score against each TLD's own population**, not a global threshold — a 4× spread makes one cross-TLD rule either too noisy or too permissive nearly everywhere.
2. **Weight the registration cohort, not just the domain.** Domains registered in the same bulk event share infrastructure and intent — identifying one exposes the rest, including those still dark.

BRAND PROTECTION

1. **Watch the registration feed for your brand**, not just the live web. The median malicious domain is dormant ~2 weeks — the cheapest, quietest point to catch a lookalike targeting you.
2. **Deseasonalise before alerting**, and exclude registry promotional co-movement, or you will chase commercial events.